

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations | Microsoft Sentinel + KQL | Defender XDR | Threat Hunting | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security analyst with more than five years of experience in Security Operations, Incident Response and Defensive Operations (DefOps). I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management) with Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rule development, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and proactive threat hunting aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. In my current role at the University of the Arts London I conduct advanced investigations escalated from our Managed Detection and Response (MDR) Security Operations Centre (SOC), lead the full Incident Response (IR) lifecycle from detection and analysis through containment, eradication, recovery and lessons learned, and develop IR playbooks and procedures. I build and tune KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, perform threat hunts using MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis and threat intelligence, and convert findings into actionable detection improvements. I also hold expert-level operational experience with CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover). I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, which I consider directly equivalent to the GIAC and CREST certifications sought for this role, and I have deep practical knowledge of ISO 27001, the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework, the NIS2 Directive and the National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) Cyber Assessment Framework (CAF). I am seeking a fully remote senior analyst position where I can contribute to and help develop a mature Defensive Operations function.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM (Microsoft Sentinel):** KQL query development, analytics rule creation and tuning, workbooks, data collection rules, log source onboarding, SOAR automation (Logic Apps, Sentinel Automations)
- **Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender -- enterprise deployment (8,000 users)
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover -- Expert
- **Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, hypothesis-led hunting, TTP-based telemetry investigation, threat intelligence integration
- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle per NIST 800-61 -- detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned; IR playbook development; root cause analysis; evidence gathering
- **Detection Engineering:** SIEM analytics rule creation and tuning, detection-as-code, coverage mapping to MITRE ATT&CK
- **MDR SOC Collaboration:** Advanced investigation of escalated alerts, L2/L3 case handling, stakeholder communication
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR playbook development
- **Frameworks:** ISO 27001, NIST CSF, NIS2 Directive, NCSC CAF, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer - University of the Arts, London (UK) - March 2025 - Present
SOC: perform root cause analysis, gather and preserve evidence, execute containment and remediation actions across Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR.

- Lead Incident Response activities through the full lifecycle per NIST 800-61: detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery and lessons learned; author and maintain IR playbooks and runbooks covering ransomware, phishing, insider threat and data exfiltration scenarios.
- Perform proactive threat hunts informed by MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, current threat intelligence and incident learnings; convert findings into detection rule improvements or tuning recommendations within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Develop and maintain KQL-based analytics rules, workbooks and SOAR automation workflows in Microsoft Sentinel; manage data collection rules, log source onboarding and platform health monitoring.
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) across the enterprise; configure detection policies, investigate endpoint alerts and lead L2/L3 incident escalations.
- Administer the vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation; identify control gaps and drive remediation aligned to MITRE ATT&CK coverage.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD identity security controls; administer Conditional Access, MFA and SSO policies.
- Support ISO 27001 controls, NIST CSF assessments, NIS2 compliance activities and Cyber Essentials Plus certification; contribute to security programme governance and reporting.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to communicate incident trends, detection gaps and workflow improvements to leadership and stakeholders.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity - University of the Arts London (UAL) March 2022 -- March 2025
 Managed, investigated and responded to security incidents using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; escalated advanced threats for L2/L3 investigation and managed case lifecycle documentation.

- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) to 8,000 users; configured detection analytics, automated response actions and Defender for Identity sensors.
- Conducted incident response activities: performed evidence gathering, documented containment steps, contributed to post-incident reviews and IR playbook updates.
- Developed and tuned KQL analytics rules and SIEM detection content; maintained detection rule library aligned to MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck; produced remediation reports and tracked closure of findings with technical teams.
- Administered Azure AD and Conditional Access policies; maintained identity security posture aligned to organisational security requirements.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 audit preparation, Cyber Essentials Plus certification and NIST CSF maturity assessment activities.
- Produced threat intelligence and detection performance reports; delivered security awareness training to 8,000+ users.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure - HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) February 2021 -- March 2022
 Supported Security Operations, Infrastructure Hardening and Quality Assurance within a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, maintaining security baselines across cloud and on-premises systems.

- Monitored and investigated security events; escalated confirmed incidents per defined IR procedures and performed initial containment actions.
- Configured Microsoft 365 security controls, Azure AD, MFA and role-based access control (RBAC); managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and tracked remediation of findings from internal assessments; supported penetration test scoping and remediation validation.
- Contributed to security policy development, compliance activities and NIST-aligned security programme documentation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and executed proactive threat hunting campaigns using MITRE ATT&CK TTP mapping and threat intelligence, identifying previously undetected adversary activity and translating findings into high-fidelity Microsoft Sentinel detection rules.

- Led end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) for an 8,000-user estate; established enterprise detection analytics, identity protection sensors and automated response workflows at scale.
- Developed a comprehensive IR playbook library aligned to NIST 800-61, covering ransomware, phishing, insider threat and credential compromise -- reducing mean time to respond for high-severity incidents.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation programme providing continuous automated red team validation; closed identified MITRE ATT&CK coverage gaps through targeted Sentinel analytics rule development.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification and contributed to ISO 27001 and NIST CSF compliance activities, supporting the organisation's wider security programme maturity.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000+ | Remote (UK)